

Zero Article

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The zero article (no article) is used when a noun is general. Main cases:

- 1 Plurals and uncountables in general — Cats are clean; Advice is useful.
- 2 Names, most countries, cities, languages — Maria, Japan, Madrid, English.
- 3 Fixed phrases — go to school, at work, by bus, have lunch.

Switch to 'the' when you mean a specific one: 'I love music' (general) vs 'the music at the party' (specific).

At a glance

Case	Example
General plurals	Cars pollute cities.
Uncountables in general	Water is essential.
Names, countries, cities	Anna lives in Japan .
Languages and subjects	She teaches French .
Meals	Let's have lunch .
Fixed phrases	go to bed , at home , by car

Learning objectives

- Can omit the article with general plurals and uncountables (CEFR B1).
- Can use the zero article with names, most countries, languages and meals.
- Can use common fixed phrases (go to bed, at work, by car) correctly.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Zero Article · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. ____ are loyal animals. (in general)

- A. The dogs
- C. A dogs

- B. Dogs
- D. An dogs

2. ____ is essential for life. (in general)

- A. The water
- C. Water

- B. A water
- D. An water

3. I usually have ____ at eight.

- A. breakfast
- C. a breakfast

- B. the breakfast
- D. an breakfast

4. The children go to ____ by bus.

- A. school
- C. a school

- B. the school
- D. an school

5. ____ lives in ____ . (a person and a country)

- A. The Sara / the Italy
- C. A Sara / an Italy

- B. Sara / Italy
- D. Sara / the Italy

6. ____ can't buy happiness.

- A. The money
- C. Money

- B. A money
- D. An money

7. She's learning ____ at university.

- A. Japanese
- C. a Japanese

- B. the Japanese
- D. an Japanese

8. Correct this: 'I go to the bed at eleven.'

- A. I go to bed at eleven.
- C. I go to an bed at eleven.

- B. I go to a bed at eleven.
- D. The sentence is already correct.

9. Which sentence talks about music IN GENERAL?

- A. I love music.
- C. I love a music.

- B. I love the music.
- D. I love an music.

10. When do you use the zero article (no article)?

- A. With general plurals and uncountables.
- C. With a singular countable first mention.

- B. With a specific, known noun.
- D. With superlatives.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. Dogs** — General plurals take no article: 'Dogs are loyal animals'.
2. **C. Water** — Uncountables in general take no article: 'Water is essential'.
3. **A. breakfast** — Meals take no article: 'have breakfast'.
4. **A. school** — 'Go to school' (as students) takes no article.
5. **B. Sara / Italy** — 'Sara lives in Italy' — no article with names or most countries.
6. **C. Money** — Uncountable in general: 'Money can't buy happiness'.
7. **A. Japanese** — Languages take no article: 'learning Japanese'.
8. **A. I go to bed at eleven.** — The fixed phrase is 'go to bed' — no article.
9. **A. I love music.** — General uncountable: 'I love music' (no article).
10. **A. With general plurals and uncountables.** — General plurals and uncountables take no article.